

Google Code Search

In the recent past, some companies have started Internet code search engines—Coders and CodeHound, for example. However, it wasn't until Google came out with Code Search (www.google.com/codesearch) that industry watchers and programmers stood up and took interest.

2.1 Code Search (www.google.com/codesearch)



The Internet is a huge repository of source code written in various languages—new, current, and defunct. Much of this code is kept in publicly accessible domains. However, the real issue is being able to locate such domains. Google Code Search takes advantage of the archives on the Web that index code, as also repositories from SourceForge and Google Code, both of which host open source projects.

Google's regular Googlebot crawler is being used to crawl through archives (.tar, .zip, etc.) and repositories such as CVS and Subversion, and index all the individual files within.